

Paper A-07: Earth Biodiversity: A Constraint-Driven Flux Dynamics (CDFD) Perspective

Steve Bico Mujjabi, MD

Independent Researcher

Founder, Vura Labs

Kampala, Uganda

ORCID: 0009-0001-0556-5516

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Shared Part IV notation and evidence boundaries are defined in PART_IV_METHODS_AND_CLAIM_BOUNDARY.md. This paper states only its local observables, comparison, and failure conditions.

Abstract

This paper develops a falsifiable CDFD/AFL model of Earth Biodiversity. It maps colonization, energy supply, disturbance, and environmental change to driving flux Φ , habitat area, fragmentation, resource limits, and interaction structure to active constraint C , functional redundancy, dispersal, refugia, and adaptation to responsiveness S , and extinction debt, genetic erosion, invasion, and disturbance history to structural memory M_s . The target outcome is persistence, turnover, function, and extinction risk, tested against species inventories, occupancy time series, trait data, genetics, and remote sensing. The paper treats universality as a shared model architecture rather than an assertion that unlike systems have the same material mechanism. It states the negative result that would make the mapping unnecessary and places the domain claim inside the cumulative CDFD programme and its reproducible runtime boundary.

1 Introduction

A rainforest and a monoculture cornfield may receive a comparable solar energy flux, yet their thermodynamic stability is vastly different. A minor drought will destroy the cornfield, while the rainforest barely registers the perturbation.

In CDFD, this resilience is not magic; it is pure topological elasticity. Biodiversity is the physical manifestation of an ecosystem's capacity to bend its constraints to absorb incoming flux.

2 Biodiversity as Responsiveness (S)

We govern the resilience of an ecosystem using the Adaptive Operating Ratio:

$$\Psi_s = \left(\frac{\Phi}{C} \right) \cdot S \cdot M_s \quad (1)$$

In an ecological context:

- **Flux (Φ):** The total energetic and material throughput of the environment (sunlight, water, carbon).
- **Constraint (C):** Environmental friction, such as temperature extremes, pathogens, or physical barriers.
- **Responsiveness (S): Biodiversity.** The sheer number of different genetic and phenotypic pathways available to route energy. If one species fails, another immediately fills the niche, ensuring the total throughput Φ is maintained.
- **Memory (M_s):** Ecological specialization. As environments remain stable for millions of years, species over-specialize to maximize efficiency, heavily locking the system into specific inter-dependencies.

2.1 Monocultures and the Mathematics of Fragility

In a highly diverse ecosystem, S is large. If a constraint C spikes (e.g., a new disease), the high S ensures Ψ_s remains stable near 1.

In human-engineered monocultures (e.g., a vast plantation of genetically identical bananas), S is artificially forced to a near-zero minimum. To keep the system producing ($\Psi_s \approx 1$), humans must artificially force the environmental constraints to zero ($C \rightarrow 0$) using massive applications of pesticides and fertilizers.

This state is a thermodynamic house of cards. The moment human intervention ceases and a natural constraint reappears (C spikes), the denominator overwhelms the equation. Because S is fundamentally broken, the system instantly collapses into a $\Psi_s \ll 1$ state of total necrosis.

3 Measurement Layer

4 Cross-Domain Model Upgrade: Mechanism, Scale, and Tests

4.1 Observable Translation

The paper-specific translation begins with an observable chain rather than a verbal analogy. For Earth Biodiversity, the proposed drive is colonization, energy supply, disturbance, and environmental change. The active limitation is habitat area, fragmentation, resource limits, and interaction structure. Responsiveness is carried by functional redundancy, dispersal, refugia, and adaptation, while retained state is represented by extinction debt, genetic erosion, invasion, and disturbance history. The outcome to explain is persistence, turnover, function, and extinction risk.

Table 1: Operational CDFD/AFL map for Paper A-07.

Term	Paper-specific observable meaning	Measurement question
Φ	colonization, energy supply, disturbance, and environmental change	What rate, load, gradient, or demand enters the focal system?
C	habitat area, fragmentation, resource limits, and interaction structure	Which measured bottleneck limits transfer, function, or recovery?
S	functional redundancy, dispersal, refugia, and adaptation	Which process changes effective capacity or reroutes the load?
M_s	extinction debt, genetic erosion, invasion, and disturbance history	Which retained state makes equal present loads produce different futures?
Y	persistence, turnover, function, and extinction risk	Which outcome is predicted out of sample, with uncertainty?

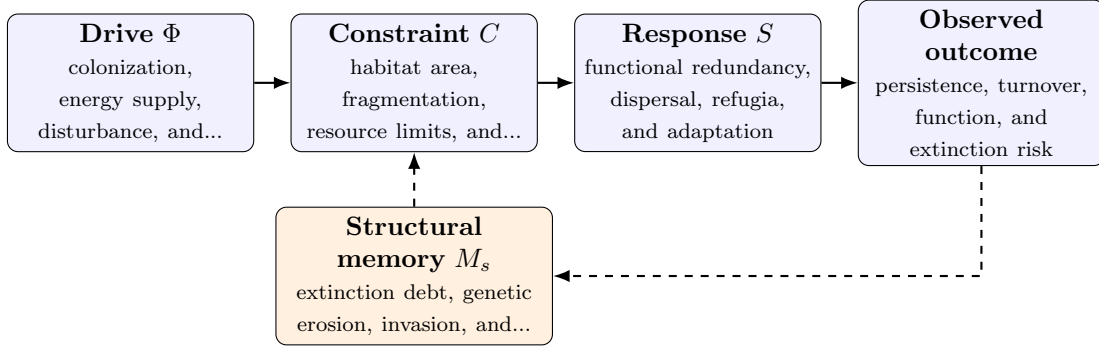


Figure 1: Paper A-07 observable CDFD/AFL architecture for Earth Biodiversity. Solid arrows give the proposed forward chain; dashed arrows make history-dependent feedback explicit.

4.2 Paper-Specific Causal Hypothesis

For this paper, the hypothesized causal sequence is specific. A change in colonization, energy supply, disturbance, and environmental change arrives faster than functional redundancy, dispersal, refugia, and adaptation can compensate. This raises or redistributes habitat area, fragmentation, resource limits, and interaction structure. If the load persists, the retained state encoded by extinction debt, genetic erosion, invasion, and disturbance history changes the next response, so a later event of equal magnitude can produce a different trajectory in persistence, turnover, function, and extinction risk. The scientific task is to estimate that sequence against the best ordinary model of the domain, not merely to redescribe the outcome after it occurs.

4.3 Cross-Scale Translation Without Mechanistic Erasure

For the Earth systems family, the cross-domain translation compares coupled transport, finite environmental capacity, buffering, and retained landscape or ecosystem state. It cannot erase conservation laws, geometry, or scale; it must expose where those domain equations create comparable overload and recovery structures. [2, 3, 1] The required scale declaration for this paper is generations to millennia; populations to biomes. At short scales, the key question is whether the incoming drive is transmitted, buffered, or diverted. At intermediate scales, response changes effective capacity and network exposure. At long scales, retained structure can alter the state space itself. A result is genuinely cross-scale only when the aggregation rule is stated and the same conclusion is not an artifact of averaging.

4.4 Evidence Ladder and Discriminating Tests

Table 2: Evidence ladder for Paper A-07. Each rung can fail independently.

Test	Design	Discriminating result
Proxy audit	Measure species inventories, occupancy time series, trait data, genetics, and remote sensing and preregister how each record maps to Φ , C , S , M_s , and Y .	The mapping fails if proxies are non-identifiable, circular, or change meaning across cases.
Load ramp	Apply or observe fragmentation followed by reconnection or habitat restoration while estimating the dominant constraint and response time.	A threshold claim requires a reproducible nonlinear change and uncertainty bounds, not a visually chosen breakpoint.
Recovery and memory	Match present load across units with different histories, then compare recovery paths.	The memory claim requires history-dependent divergence after current conditions are controlled.
Model comparison	Compare the baseline domain model with and without the CDFD/AFL state variables using held-out data.	The paper’s stated falsifier is: prior fragmentation history does not alter recovery after present habitat is matched.

4.5 Research Programme and Boundary Conditions

The immediate research programme has four steps. First, construct a documented dataset from species inventories, occupancy time series, trait data, genetics, and remote sensing and retain raw units before normalization. Second, fit a baseline domain model and report its calibration and out-of-sample error. Third, add the smallest identifiable CDFD/AFL state extension and test whether it improves prediction of persistence, turnover, function, and extinction risk. Fourth, repeat the analysis across the declared scale range and publish negative cases as part of the cross-domain translation audit.

5 Conclusion

Biodiversity can contribute to response diversity, redundancy, and recovery, but it cannot be reduced to a single universal parameter. The CDFD hypothesis is that lower diversity can reduce measured responsiveness under specified shocks; the claim fails where low-diversity systems remain robust after confounders are controlled.

Conflict of Interest

The author declares no conflict of interest.

Data Availability

Part-specific runtime diagnostics are under each Part’s `outputs/` directory.

Release-wide code: `Part_E_Synthesis/supplementary/`.

Generated summaries: `Part_E_Synthesis/outputs/`.

Figures: `Part_E_Synthesis/figures/`.

6 Reference Layer

References

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